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<https://www.google.com/maps/d/edit?mid=1TN2-i9JQ-RGT36xf2Xs7lloH1pV01WY&ll=11.712278635852897%2C0&z=2>

Research Documentation (300-500 words)

I used Google MyMaps, which has a built-in search function to search for locations. In addition to this, I did complete some google searches to find more precise addresses of certain data centers, especially for Amazon Web Services (AWS) centers. This was challenging because Amazon AWS is very secretive about where their locations are. Many of these locations operate under nondescript names, rather than saying “amazon” on them. I found this interesting, and it made me wonder why they do this, but I assume it is a security thing. This was somewhat surprising to me because Amazon is such a big company, but I also wonder whether this is because they are trying to keep the Amazon delivery service separate from the Amazon AWS service. I learned that Amazon AWS is a major part of data and internet, which I did not know before, I thought Amazon was only a delivery service as well as a streaming platform on Prime Video. It was much easier to find data centers for Microsoft. Something else I found interesting was that the mining sites were nearly impossible to find. This was a layer I was thinking to add to my map, but since they were very hard to locate, I had to leave this section out. This connects to the idea of the visibility and selectivity of data, because sometimes the data that isn’t visible tells a story too. I was curious why this would be, but it seems that there are human rights exploitations as well as the plundering of resources from these areas, and it makes sense that these companies would try to hide this information. This reveals a lot about the companies and their priorities being more on money than about caring for local people and nature.

Artist Statement (250 words)

All of the headquarters for the companies I documented (OpenAI, Google, Microsoft, Meta, Amazon AWS, and Anthropic) were on the West Coast, primarily in California but also in Washington. Conversely, all of the data centers were either in the Midwest, East Coast, or international regions, primarily in Europe for the ones I found. This was interesting to me, and I know that Silicon Valley in California is a large hub for technology, but I wonder why there were no headquarters in New York as well. This map makes the argument that there are headquarters in one central location and data centers and offices all over other regions, mostly for the economic benefit of the companies. This can have detrimental outcomes for the local people in these places, as

they are often not involved in choosing the companies being located there, as well as their ecosystems being affected by the environmental effects of the company. This shows that companies are prioritizing money and power over where they are located, especially in regards to the people and nature that were there. Something I noticed was that a lot of the data centers, specifically for Amazon, were hidden. This was something that connected to the idea of data feminism because it shows that there are reasons why it is not being shown, which shows its importance. This also connects to the ideas of structural inequality and environmental effects of a company's participation in a certain region, which all relate to the ideas of equality and collaboration.

Attribution

I used Google MyMaps (mymaps.google.com) to complete this project. It had an inherent search function that I used to locate the data sites. AI was not explicitly used to complete this project.